

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Inference from sample statistics and margin of error	Easy

Question

A city has 50 city council members. A reporter polled a random sample of 20 city council members and found that 6 of those polled supported a specific bill. Based on the sample, which of the following is the best estimate of the number of city council members in the city who support the bill?

Answer

- A. 6
- B. 9
- C. 15
- D. 30

Rationale

Choice C is correct. Because a random sample of the city council was polled, the proportion of the sample who supported the bill is expected to be approximately equal to the proportion of the total city council who supports the bill. Since 6 of the 20 polled, or 30%, supported the bill, it can be estimated that 50×0.3 , or 15, city council members support the bill.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the number of city council members in the sample who supported the bill. Choice B is incorrect and may result from a computational error. Choice D is incorrect. This is the number of city council members in the sample of city council members who were not polled.